DO YOU KNOW?

WORLD SIDDHA DAY

14th APRIL

12.9.5 Concept of Drugs

The drugs used by the Siddhars could be classified into three groups:

- Thavaram (herbal product)
- Thathu (inorganic substances)
- Jangamam (animal products).

The thathu drugs are further classified as

- Uppu (water soluble inorganic substances or drugs that give out vapour when put into fire)
- Pashanam (drugs not dissolved in water but emit vapour when fired),
- Uparasam (similar to pashanam but differ in action),
- Loham (not dissolved in water but melt when fired),
- Rasam (drugs which are soft) and
- Ghandhagam (drugs which are insoluble in water, like sulphor).

The drugs used in Siddha medicine were classified on the basis of five properties:

- Suvai (taste),
- Guna (character),
- Veerya (potency),
- Pirivu (class)
- Mahimai (action).

According to their mode of application the Siddha medicine could be categorized into two classes: (1) internal medicine and (2) external medicine.

- Internal medicine was used through the oral route and further classified in to 32 categories based on their form, methods of preparation, shelf life, etc.
- External medicine includes certain forms of drugs and also certain applications like nasal, eye and ear drops and also certain procedures like leech application.

12.9.6 Treatment

The treatment should be commenced as early as possible after assessing the course and cause of the disease.

Treatment is classified into three categories:

- Devamaruthuvum (Divine method) - like parpam, chendooram, guru, kuligai made of mercury, sulphur and pashanams are used.
- Manuda maruthuvum (rational method) - medicines made of herbs like *churanam*, *kudineer*, *vadagam* are used.
- Asura maruthuvum (surgical method) - incision, excision, heat application, blood letting, leech application are used.

According to therapies the treatments of Siddha medicines could be further categorized into following categories such as Purgative therapy, Emetic therapy, Fasting therapy, Steam therapy, Oleation therapy, Physical therapy, Solar therapy and Blood letting therapy, Yoga therapy, etc.

- The diagnosis of the disease is by the identification of causative factors is through examination of pulse, urine, eyes, study of voice, colour of body, tongue and status of the digestive treatment.

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